

Workshop

We list ten simple to advanced tweaks that you can use to improve performance on Linux.

Tips & tricks

Learn to use tricks for Evernote, OSX Yosemite and Microsoft Outlook to work like a boss.

Graphics driver woes, minimum system requirements #Fail, SSD buying confusion. Ohh! the horror...

Can a SSD run on IDE? Can my ageing desktop play the current crop of games? How do I update my graphics card drivers? We answer them all.

Q SSD on IDE

I have a Gigabyte G41MT-S2P (Socket 775) motherboard. Will an SSD run properly on my system? I read somewhere that it needs AHCI, so I looked for it and didn't find anything. Also ICH7 doesn't have that. My board has ICH7/R. Some say that SSDs will run fine on IDE. I can't find a proper answer for it. Help me please. Thank You.

- Nikhil Chopra

A AHCI is necessary for certain features to work but SSDs do work if the controller is set to IDE mode. As for ICH7 having AHCI or not, the Wikipedia page says it does and here's the exact line which can be verified by going through the ICH7 datasheet as well - "Only the ICH7DH, ICH7R, ICH7-M, ICH7-M DH chip have AHCI support". But it would be better to check your BIOS to see if you can set AHCI or not. There will be a drop in performance if you use IDE and people have run benchmarks of SSDs on IDE as well as AHCI. Here is a good benchmark: <http://dgit.in/IDEvs.AHCI>. So you can run an SSD with the controller set to IDE. However, for your motherboard, we have found one mention where someone has used an SSD but not only did the person get lower speeds, but the entire capacity of the drive could not be utilised. We'd suggest getting in touch with Gigabyte for further clarification.

Q Can I update drivers?

Hey Team Digit, I have an Alienware X51 Series desktop with these specifications:

- Processor - Intel Core i5-4460;
- GPU - Nvidia GTX 745 (OEM);
- RAM - 8GB (1666 something MHz, I don't know)

My question is that, can I update my graphics driver because GTX 745 (OEM) seems rare to me and I've never heard of it. Also please mention whether I can upgrade my graphics hardware and RAM too. Thanks.

- Debasmith Mandal

A Though the NVIDIA GTX 745 OEM card is only available through custom built machines, it is still listed on the NVIDIA drivers website. So yeah, you can update your drivers without worry. And since NVIDIA GeForce Experience checks for updates automatically, you needn't worry about checking for compatibility since the software does it for you.

The GTX 745 is a discrete card so you can easily pop it out and replace it with any other SKU while making sure that your PSU can power it. You can also upgrade your RAM which is probably running at 1600 MHz currently unless there is some overclocking that was done by the manufacturer. Running a system information tool like Speccy should help, but you can use any 1600 MHz module running on the same voltage since the



Select your GPU model from the dropdown list.

Alienware website states that to be the default configuration.

Q Can I run it?

Hi Team Digit, I have a problem at hand. My system configuration is:

Intel Core i3 530 2.93GHz;
4 GB DDR3 RAM;
500 GB Seagate Hard Disk;
Intel DH55TC Motherboard;



The Sapphire Radeon R7 250 1GB is a good card to go for.

Is my system configuration enough to play games like COD:Advanced Warfare, Far Cry 3, Crisis 3? If not, what component of my system should I upgrade? My budget is within Rs.6000. Thanks in advance.

-Aravindan Sridhar

A Dear reader, looking at your dilemma, we suggest that since you have money to purchase games like Call of Duty: Advanced Warfare, FarCry 3 and Crysis 3 each of which retail for \$60, you can certainly save some money and invest more of it into upgrading your PC as a whole. For playing current games at good frame rates, you need a decent GPU. In your current budget, you can only go for the Sapphire AMD Radeon R7 250 1GB which is okay for that budget. Don't expect to get much of a visual experience using it though. **[E]**